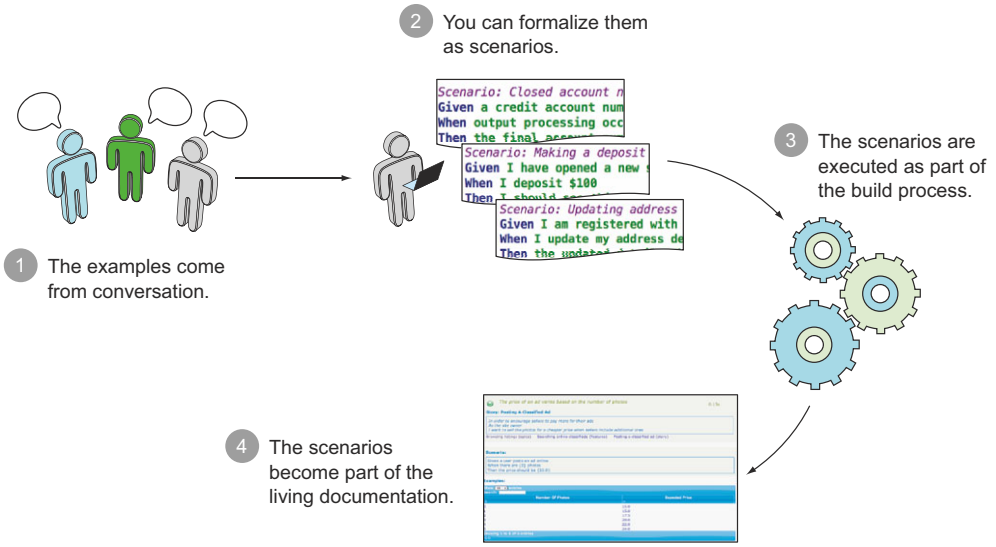


Figure 5.3 When examples are expressed as scenarios, they can be automated and used to generate living documentation.

Although the example is a little more stylized than a free-text paragraph, you're still speaking the language of the stakeholders. With a little practice, stakeholders quickly become comfortable enough with the format to be able to propose and discuss examples like this one.

This approach works equally well when the native language of the stakeholders is not English: you can write scenarios like this in any language. For example, here's the equivalent of this scenario in French:[1]

```
Scénario: Gagner des points standards sur un vol en Economy
Etant donné que la distance entre Sydney et Melbourne est de 878 km
Et que je suis un member Frequent Flyer standard
Quand je voyage de Sydney jusqu'à Melbourne
Alors je devrait gagner 439 points
```

This sort of scenario is not only quite readable, it's also executable: BDD tools like JBehave and Cucumber can read and execute these scenarios to verify your application's behavior and generate meaningful test reports. These test reports are a central part of the living documentation that will help you understand and maintain the application (see figure 5.3).

We'll look at how you can take advantage of this sort of automation in chapter 6. But first, you need to learn how to write effective scenarios in this format using tools like Cucumber and JBehave.

[1] This is the French version for JBehave; the Cucumber version is slightly different.